

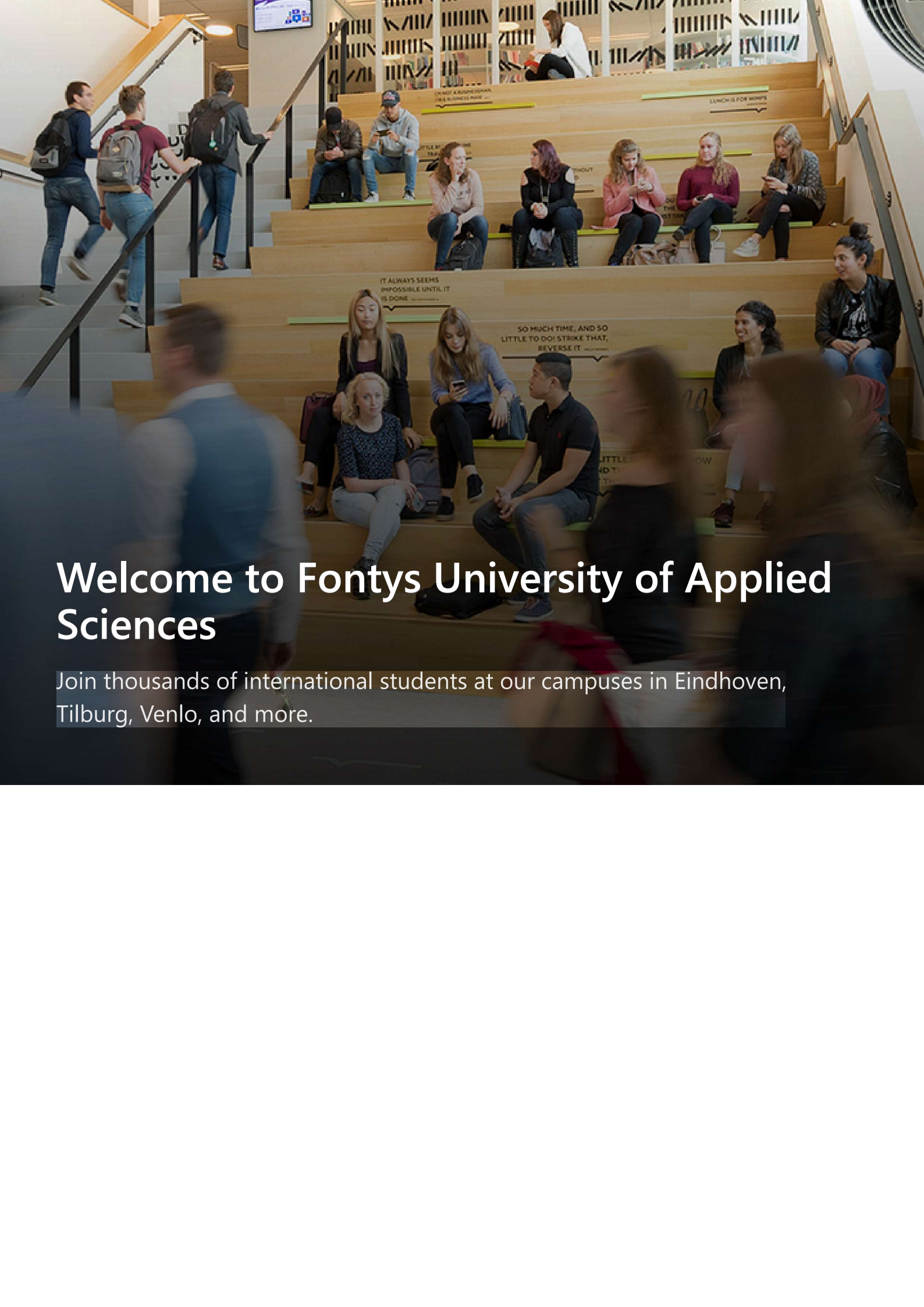


GUIDE 1

Admission & Application

Your complete step-by-step guide to studying at Fontys

🕒 Start 6-12 months before 🎓 All Bachelor programmes



Welcome to Fontys University of Applied Sciences

Join thousands of international students at our campuses in Eindhoven, Tilburg, Venlo, and more.

Welcome to Your First Step!

Welcome to your first step towards studying at Fontys University of Applied Sciences! This guide will walk you through everything you need to do to successfully apply and get accepted. Don't worry - we'll take it step by step, and by the end, you'll be officially enrolled as a Fontys student.

This guide applies to ALL Fontys campuses (Eindhoven, Tilburg, Venlo, etc.) and ALL Bachelor programmes.



Timeline

Start 6-12 months before you want to begin studying



Difficulty Level

Medium - lots of paperwork, but totally doable!

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Check If You're Eligible for Fontys

Before you apply, you need to make sure you meet the basic requirements. Let's check what you need.

What Documents Do You Need?

✓ EVERYONE (EU + Non-EU) needs:

- ☐ Valid secondary school diploma accepted by Fontys
- ☐ English language test results (if required): IELTS or TOEFL
- ☐ Study Choice Check completion (if required by your programme)

! Non-EU students ALSO need:

- ☐ Diploma evaluation from Nuffic
- ☐ Translated and legalized diploma documents

How Do I Know If My Diploma Is Accepted?

The fastest way to check if your diploma is valid is to contact the specific Fontys programme you want to apply for directly.

Contact the programme:

- 1 Go to the Fontys website: www.fontys.nl/en
- 2 Find your programme (example: ICT, Business, Engineering, etc.)
- 3 Look for contact information (usually: programme.name@fontys.nl)
- 4 Email them with:
 - Your country
 - Type of diploma you have
 - Which programme you want to study

They will tell you within a few days if your diploma is accepted.

Non-EU Students: Diploma Evaluation Process

If you're from outside the EU/EEA, you need to get your diploma evaluated. Here's how:

Step 1: Check with the Dutch Government (Rijksoverheid)

- Go to: www.rijksoverheid.nl
- Search for "diploma waardering" (diploma recognition)
- They will tell you if Fontys can evaluate your diploma directly OR if you need Nuffic

Step 2: Nuffic evaluation (if required)

- Go to: www.nuffic.nl/en/diplomawaardering
- Create an account and submit your diploma
- Pay the fee: approximately €130
- Wait 4-8 weeks for your evaluation certificate
- Upload this certificate when you apply via Studielink

 Important: Start this process EARLY - it can take 2+ months!

English Language Requirements

Do you need an English test?

✓ YES: If your previous education was NOT in English

X NO: If you studied completely in English (you need proof of this)

Which test and what scores?

For most Fontys programmes:

IELTS Academic

6.0

Minimum overall
(no section below 5.5)

TOEFL iBT

80

Minimum overall

Important notes:

- Some programmes may require HIGHER scores - always check your specific programme requirements
- Your test certificate must be less than 2 years old when you start studying
- Native English speakers: contact the Fontys admissions office to ask about exemptions

Where can you take these tests?

IELTS:

1. Go to: www.ielts.org
2. Find a test center in your country
3. Book your test (cost: approximately €200-250)
4. Prepare using free materials on their website
5. Take the test
6. Receive results in 2-3 weeks

TOEFL:

1. Go to: www.ets.org/toefl
2. Create an ETS account
3. Find a test center or take it online at home
4. Book your test (cost: approximately €200-250)
5. Take the test
6. Receive results in 6-10 days

 **Tip:** Book your test 2-3 months before your application deadline. Give yourself time to retake it if needed!

Study Choice Check

What is this?

The Study Choice Check is a tool to help you determine if the study programme suits your interests and will benefit your chances of enjoying your time at Fontys and succeeding in your career Fontys.

Do you need to do this?

Participation in the Study Choice Check is not compulsory for students applying for admission on the basis of an international diploma Fontys.

How does it work if your programme requires it?

- 1 After you apply via Studielink, you'll receive an email with a link
- 2 Complete an online questionnaire
- 3 Attend an online contact moment (video call) with the programme
- 4 You'll receive study choice advice

This is NOT a test - it's just to help you make sure this is the right programme for you.

✓ CHECKLIST: Are you ready to apply?

Before moving to Step 2, check that you have:

- ☐ Confirmed your diploma is accepted (contacted programme)
- ☐ Completed English language test (if required) or have exemption
- ☐ Started Nuffic evaluation process (Non-EU only, if required)
- ☐ All documents ready to upload

Create Your Studielink Account

What is Studielink?

Studielink is THE official Dutch system for all higher education applications. Every student in the Netherlands must use it. Without Studielink, you cannot apply to Fontys.

Link: www.studielink.nl

Creating your account (step-by-step)

1. Go to Studielink

- Visit: www.studielink.nl
- Click "Create Studielink-account without DigiD"

Important for international students: You do NOT need a DigiD to create your account. DigiD is only for people who already live in the Netherlands.

2. Upload your ID document

You will need to upload a scan or photo of your passport or European identity card Studielink

- ☐ Accepted formats: JPEG, PNG, BMP, or PDF
- ☐ Make sure the image is clear and shows the entire document
- ☐ For passports: upload the page with your photo
- ☐ For ID cards: upload both front and back

Tips for a good scan:

- Take the photo in good lighting
- Make sure all corners of the document are visible
- The document should be flat and centered
- Make sure the Machine Readable Zone (MRZ - the lines at the bottom) is clearly visible

3. Enter your personal details

- ☐ Full name (EXACTLY as it appears on your passport!)
- ☐ Date of birth
- ☐ Place and country of birth
- ☐ Gender

4. Enter your address

- ☐ If you're still in your home country: enter your home address there
- ☐ If you're already in the Netherlands: enter your Dutch address

5. Enter contact details

- ✉ Email address (VERY IMPORTANT - use an email only YOU can access)

This email will receive ALL important information

Check this email EVERY DAY after applying!

- 📞 Phone number with country code

6. Verify your email

- Check your inbox (and spam folder!)
- Click the verification link
- Your account is now activated!

7. Log in

- Go back to www.studielink.nl
- Log in with your email and password



Congratulations! You now have a Studielink account.

✓ CHECKLIST: Studielink account

- ☐ Created Studielink account
- ☐ Uploaded clear ID document
- ☐ Verified email address
- ☐ Can log in successfully

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Apply via Studielink

Now you're ready to submit your actual application to Fontys!

CHECK THE DEADLINES FIRST!

This is critical - don't miss these dates!

Dutch students:

- ☐ September start: Apply before 1 May (final deadline 31 August)
- ☐ February start: Apply before 1 February (final deadline 31 January)

EU/EEA students:

- ☐ September start: Apply before 1 June
- ☐ February start: Apply before 15 November

Non-EU/EEA students:

- ☐ September start: Apply before 1 June
- ☐ February start: Apply before 15 November Fontys

IMPORTANT: If you apply after these dates, Fontys cannot guarantee enough time to arrange your visa and residence permit Fontys.

 **Tip:** Don't wait until the last day! Apply at least 1-2 months before the deadline to avoid technical problems.

Submitting your application (step-by-step)

1. Log in to Studielink

- Go to www.studielink.nl
- Log in with your email and password

2. Add your previous education

- Click "Add previous education"
- Select the country where you got your diploma
- Select your type of diploma
- Enter the name of your school
- Enter your graduation date (or expected date)

3. Start your application

- Click "Add new enrolment" or "Inschrijven"
- Select the academic year you want to start
- Select "September" or "February" start date

4. Find Fontys

- In the search box, type "Fontys"
- Select "Fontys Hogescholen" or "Fontys University of Applied Sciences"
- Select your specific campus:
 - Fontys Hogeschool Eindhoven
 - Fontys Hogeschool Tilburg
 - Fontys Hogeschool Venlo
 - (or other campus)

5. Select your programme

- Find your programme (example: "ICT", "International Business", "Engineering")
- Check the language: English or Dutch
- Check if it's Full-time or Part-time
- Click to select

6. Fill in the application form

You'll need to provide:

- ☐ Personal information (already filled from your account)
- ☐ Address details
- ☐ Previous education details
- ☐ Motivation (some programmes ask why you want to study this)
- ☐ Any programme-specific questions

7. Check everything carefully

- Review ALL information before submitting
- Make sure your name matches your passport EXACTLY
- Make sure your email is correct
- Use the "Back" button if you need to change anything

8. Submit your application

- Click "Submit" or "Versturen"
- You will receive a confirmation email immediately
- Save this email!

What about application fees?

Good news: There is NO application fee for Fontys Fontys. You only pay tuition fees after you're accepted.

CHECKLIST: Application submitted

- ☐ Application submitted before deadline
- ☐ Received confirmation email from Studielink
- ☐ Saved confirmation email
- ☐ Checked application status in Studielink dashboard

Upload Your Documents

After submitting your application in Studielink, Fontys will contact you about uploading documents.

What documents do you need?

EU students need:

-  Copy of your diploma
-  Transcript of grades
-  Copy of your passport or European ID card
-  English language test results (IELTS/TOEFL certificate)
-  CV (if requested by your programme)
-  Motivation letter (if requested)

Non-EU students need everything above PLUS:

-  Nuffic diploma evaluation certificate (very important!)
-  Officially translated diploma (by certified translator)
-  Legalized/apostilled diploma (with official stamps)
-  All pages of your passport (not just the photo page)
-  Passport photo (passport format)

How to upload documents

You CANNOT upload documents directly in Studielink. You must submit all documents required for your admission to the educational institution directly Studielink.

Here's what happens:

- 1 After your Studielink application, Fontys will send you an email
- 2 This email contains a link to their document upload portal
- 3 Log in with the credentials provided in the email
- 4 Upload all your documents there

If you don't receive this email within 1 week:

- ☐ Check your spam folder
- ☐ Contact: international@fontys.nl
- ☐ Subject line: "Document upload - [Your Name] - [Student Number]"

Document requirements:

- ☐ Format: PDF only
- ☐ File size: Maximum 5MB per file
- ☐ Quality: Clear and readable (no blurry scans!)
- ☐ Your name and student number should be on each document

CHECKLIST: Documents uploaded

- ☐ Received upload portal link from Fontys
- ☐ Uploaded diploma
- ☐ Uploaded transcript
- ☐ Uploaded passport/ID
- ☐ Uploaded English test results
- ☐ Uploaded Nuffic evaluation (Non-EU only)
- ☐ Uploaded translations (Non-EU only)
- ☐ Received confirmation that Fontys received documents

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Wait for Your Acceptance Letter

What happens next?

1. Document verification (1-4 weeks)

- ☐ Fontys checks all your documents
- ☐ They verify your diploma and grades
- ☐ If anything is missing, they'll email you

2. Waiting for decision

Based on available information:

-  EU students: typically 2-4 weeks after deadline
-  Non-EU students: typically 4-8 weeks after deadline

What if you don't hear anything?

If it's been longer than expected:

- ☐ Check your Studielink dashboard for updates
- ☐ Check your email (including spam!)
- ☐ Contact: international@fontys.nl
- ☐ Subject: "Application status inquiry - [Your Name] - [Student Number]"

3. Decision time

You'll receive ONE of these outcomes:

✓ **Accepted!** - You'll get a Letter of Acceptance

⚠ **Conditional acceptance** - You're accepted IF you meet certain conditions (like finishing your current studies)

✗ **Rejected** - They'll explain why



YOU'RE ACCEPTED! Now what?

Congratulations! You'll receive via email:



1. Letter of Acceptance

- ☐ This is your official acceptance document
- ☐ Save this! You'll need it for visa applications
- ☐ Keep both digital and printed copies

2. Instructions for next steps

- How to confirm your enrollment
- Tuition fee information
- Deadlines for payment

3. Information about:

- Student housing applications
- Visa procedures (Non-EU)
- Introduction activities
- Student email activation

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Finalize Your Enrollment

You're almost done! Just a few more steps to become officially enrolled.

Confirm your enrollment in Studielink

Within 2 weeks of receiving your acceptance:

- 1 Log in to Studielink
- 2 Go to "My applications" or "Mijn aanvragen"
- 3 Click on your Fontys application
- 4 Click "Confirm enrollment" or "Bevestig inschrijving"
- 5 You'll see confirmation that you're enrolled

Pay your tuition fees

EU/EEA students (statutory rate):

€2,601

per year

Non-EU/EEA students (institutional rate):

€12,480

for most programmes (can vary by programme) Fontys

How to pay:

After confirming enrollment, you'll receive payment instructions via email

You can pay via:

- ☒ Digital authorization (automatic collection) - easiest option
- ☒ Bank transfer (if you don't have a European bank account)

Payment deadline: Usually before 1 September (or 1 February for spring start)

Payment options:

Option A: Digital authorization (recommended)

- ☐ Around 15 May, you can enter your payment details in Studielink
- ☐ Choose to pay in full or in installments
- ☐ Fontys will automatically collect the payment
- ☐ First collection happens around 25 September

Option B: Bank transfer (for non-European accounts)

- ☐ Indicate in Studielink that you'll pay from a non-SEPA country
- ☐ You'll receive a payment agreement
- ☐ Sign and send it back
- ☐ Transfer the tuition fees according to instructions

Activate your Fontys student email

After enrollment is complete, you'll receive:

-  A Fontys student email: `yourname@student.fontys.nl`
-  Instructions on how to activate it
-  Your student number

Why is this important?

- ⚠ ALL official communication from Fontys will go to this email
- ⚠ You need it to access online learning platforms
- ⚠ You need it for registering for courses
- ⚠ You need it for accessing library and other facilities

Check this email DAILY once you have it!

☒ FINAL CHECKLIST: Enrollment complete!

- ☐ Confirmed enrollment in Studielink
- ☐ Tuition fees paid (or payment arrangement made)
- ☐ Received Fontys student email
- ☐ Activated Fontys student email
- ☐ Received student number
- ☐ Saved all important documents

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: I don't have my diploma yet, can I still apply?

A: Yes! You can apply with your current grades. Upload your diploma as soon as you receive it.

Q: My Nuffic evaluation is taking longer than expected, what should I do?

A: Email international@fontys.nl immediately and explain the situation. They may be able to give you more time.

Q: I made a mistake in my Studielink application, can I change it?

A: Before the deadline, you can modify your application. After the deadline, contact international@fontys.nl.

Q: What if I get rejected?

A: Fontys will explain why. You can sometimes appeal or apply for a different programme. Contact them for guidance.

Q: Can I apply to multiple programmes at Fontys?

A: Yes, but you need to submit a separate application for each programme in Studielink.

Important Links

Fontys

- Main website: www.fontys.nl/en
- Study in Netherlands: Study info
- Admission requirements: Requirements
- Application deadlines: Deadlines
- Tuition fees: Fees
- ✉ International Office: international@fontys.nl

External

- Studielink: www.studielink.nl
- Studielink account creation: Create account
- Nuffic diploma recognition: www.nuffic.nl/en
- IELTS: www.ielts.org
- TOEFL: www.ets.org/toefl

Need Help?

Having trouble or have questions? Don't worry - you're not alone!

Join our community in the app where you can:

- ✓ Ask questions to other international students
- ✓ Get advice from students who already went through this process
- ✓ Share your experiences
- ✓ Find study buddies from your country

Open Community Forum



YOU DID IT!

Congratulations on completing Guide 1! You've successfully applied and enrolled at Fontys University of Applied Sciences.

What's next?

For Non-EU/EEA students:

You now need to arrange your visa and residence permit. This is **CRITICAL** - start immediately!

→ Continue to Guide 2: Visa & Residence Permit

For EU/EEA students:

You can skip the visa guide! Your next step is finding housing.

→ Skip to Guide 3: Housing

Timeline reminder:

- **Guide 2 (Visa):** Start immediately after acceptance - takes 6-12 weeks
- **Guide 3 (Housing):** Start NOW - can take 6+ months!
- **Guide 4 (Health Insurance):** 1-2 months before arrival
- **Guide 5 (Register in NL):** Within first 5 days after arrival
- **Guide 6 (After Arrival):** First weeks in Netherlands

Good luck with your next steps! You're one step closer to your dream of studying in the Netherlands! 🎓